

August 20, 2026

UnitedHealthcare
Provider Appeals
P.O. Box 30432
Salt Lake City, UT 84130

RE: Formal Appeal of Claim Denial — Jenee Turcotte (MRN MUSC0686121), Claim MUSC-CC97-3

Patient	Jenee Turcotte (DOB 1979-12-30)
MRN	MUSC0686121
Member ID / Group	UHC683527916 / GRP-16096
Claim number	MUSC-CC97-3
Date of service	2026-06-08
Procedure billed	CPT 99214 — Office/outpatient visit, established patient, moderate complexity
Primary diagnosis	E66.9 — Obesity, unspecified
Denied amount	\$339.95
Denial code	CARC 50 / RARC N115 — These are non-covered services because this is not deemed a 'medical necessity' by the payer.
Appeal deadline	2027-06-26

Dear Appeals Review Committee:

SUMMARY OF APPEAL

MUSC Health is submitting this formal first-level appeal on behalf of patient Jenee Turcotte (MRN: MUSC0686121, Member ID: UHC683527916, Group: GRP-16096) regarding the denial of Claim MUSC-CC97-3 for services rendered on June 8, 2026, at MUSC Health Rutledge Tower Ambulatory Care. The claim was denied on June 26, 2026, under CARC 50 ("These are non-covered services because this is not deemed a 'medical necessity' by the payer") and RARC N115 ("This decision was based on a Local Coverage Determination (LCD)"), with the accompanying remark that "Documentation submitted does not establish that the service was reasonable and necessary for the diagnosis reported." MUSC Health respectfully disagrees with this determination and requests full reversal and payment at the allowed amount of \$253.66.

CLINICAL BACKGROUND

Ms. Turcotte is a 46-year-old female established patient with a documented, active diagnosis of obesity (ICD-10 E66.9), with onset recorded as May 4, 2015, and a confirmed body mass index of 30.33 kg/m² on file. She additionally carries an active diagnosis of hypertension (ICD-10 I10), with onset dating to August 10, 1998, and is currently maintained on Hydrochlorothiazide 25 mg. On June 8, 2026, she was evaluated by Dr. Priya N. Raghavan, MD (NPI 1669504132) in an established outpatient visit (CPT 99214, Revenue Code 0510, Place of Service 22) for her ongoing management of obesity. The level of service billed reflects moderate medical decision-making consistent with the management of at least two active chronic conditions, one of which — hypertension — is directly exacerbated by and clinically interrelated with obesity.

BASIS FOR APPEAL

The denial of CPT 99214 for an established patient visit addressing active obesity is not supported by the clinical record. Obesity (E66.9) is a recognized, chronic, and progressive disease with well-established associations with cardiovascular risk, including hypertension, which Ms. Turcotte has been managing pharmacologically for nearly three decades. An office visit dedicated to the evaluation and ongoing management of obesity in a patient with comorbid hypertension constitutes medically necessary care under any reasonable clinical standard. The CPT code 99214 is appropriate for an established patient encounter involving moderate complexity, which is consistent with the management of multiple active chronic conditions requiring independent interpretation of results and consideration of treatment options.

UnitedHealthcare's invocation of RARC N115 suggests reliance on a Local Coverage Determination; however, no specific LCD has been cited in the denial correspondence, and no clinical rationale has been provided explaining why the documented chronic conditions fail to meet medical necessity criteria. The absence of a specific coverage exclusion, combined with the presence of an active, documented diagnosis with a longitudinal treatment history, undermines the basis for denial. MUSC Health maintains that the documentation supports the medical necessity of this service and that the denial does not reflect a complete review of the clinical record.

REQUESTED ACTION

MUSC Health respectfully requests that UnitedHealthcare conduct a full clinical review of the submitted documentation and reverse the denial of Claim MUSC-CC97-3. We request payment of the allowed amount of \$253.66 for CPT 99214 rendered on June 8, 2026. Should the reviewer require additional clinical documentation from the treating provider, Dr. Raghavan, or from the medical record, MUSC Health will cooperate promptly to facilitate that review. If this first-level appeal is not resolved in favor of the patient, we reserve all rights to pursue subsequent levels of appeal, including external independent review, in accordance with applicable state and federal requirements.

Respectfully submitted,

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Enclosures

- Remittance advice / explanation of payment
- Itemized claim detail (UB-04 / CMS-1500)
- Relevant clinical documentation from the medical record